Lesson 17

The Kingdom of God

Aim: To help the believers know what the Kingdom of God is all about and understand its significance in their lives.

Intro:

The Kingdom of God is the central teaching of Jesus. Luke 4:43

But he said, "I must proclaim the good news of the kingdom of God to the other towns also, because that is why I was sent."

John the Baptist's preaching –

Matthew 3:1-2

"In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea, And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand."

WHAT IS THE KINGDOM OF GOD?

The Greek word is **"BASILEIA"**

-*A state or government having a king or queen as its head.*

Kingdom as a compound word.

"King" and *"dom"*, meaning a Kingdom has a King and his domain or subjects.

WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS ABOUT THE KINGDOM

1. **Not meat and drink but righteousness, and peace and joy in the Holy Ghost.**

Romans 14:17

“For the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating and drinking, but of righteousness, peace and joy in the Holy Spirit”

2. **Not in Word but in Power!**

1 Corinthians 4:20

“For the kingdom of God is not a matter of talk but of power.”

3.**The Kingdom of God is a place**

John 18:36

Jesus said, "My kingdom is not of this world. If it were, my servants would fight to prevent my arrest by the Jews. But now my kingdom is from another place."

The Kingdom of God is not food and drink. It is a lifestyle presented by the Lord Jesus Christ, available to the Christians. It is possible in the Holy Ghost. It is a lifestyle characterized by righteousness, peace, joy and power. It is found in the Lord Jesus Christ.

WHERE IS THE KINGDOM OF GOD?

Luke 17:20-21

20 Once, having been asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God would come, Jesus replied, "The kingdom of God does not come with your careful observation,

21 nor will people say, 'Here it is,' or 'There it is,' because the kingdom of God is within you."

- It is the rule of God in the hearts, minds and wills of God's people.

HOW CAN WE ENTER INTO THE KINGDOM OF GOD?

<u>Being Born - Again is the first step</u>.

John 3:3

In reply Jesus declared, "I tell you the truth, no-one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again."

What is a born-again experience?

- It is a spiritual rebirth.

John 3:5

Jesus answered, "I tell you the truth, no-one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit.

- being born of water is our means

Ephesians 5:25-27

“Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her to make her holy, cleansing[b] her by the washing with water through the word, and to

present her to himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless."

a. Being convicted in God's Word. This will lead to repentance and salvation.

Romans 10:14

"How, then, can they call on the one they have not believed in? And how can they believe in the one of whom they have not heard? And how can they hear without someone preaching to them?"

Romans 10:17

"Consequently, faith comes from hearing the message, and the message is heard through the word of Christ."

b. Being born in Water is our physical entrance in this physical world.

c. Being born in the Spirit is our spiritual entrance to the spiritual world.

The Kingdom of God is SPIRITUAL AND PHYSICAL at the same time. What we have today is a spiritual Kingdom.

Luke 17:21

“nor will people say, 'Here it is,' or 'There it is,' because the kingdom of God is within you."

But time will come when God will establish His physical Kingdom in this physical earth, where Jesus will reign as King of kings and Lord of lords.

Matthew 6:9-10

"This, then, is how you should pray: " 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be Your Name, Your kingdom come, Your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.

Revelation 11:15

“The seventh angel sounded his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, which said: "The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Christ, and he will reign for ever and ever."

Revelation 5:10

“You have made them to be a kingdom and priests to serve our God, and they will reign on the earth."

2. Being Born-again is the beginning of the New Life.

2 Corinthians 5:17

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; the old has gone, the new has come!” - it is a Christ- centered lifestyle.

2 Peter 3:18

“But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To him be glory both now and forever. Amen.”

- The emphasis of "Lord and Savior" signifies the Lordship of Jesus.

WHAT ARE THE BENEFITS OF ENTERING IN THE KINGDOM OF GOD.

1.Eternal life in heaven.

1 John 5:11-13

11 “And this is the testimony: God has given us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.12 He who has the Son has life; he who does not have the Son of God does not have life.13 I write these things to you who believe in the name of the Son of God so that you may know that you have eternal life.”

John 14:6

Jesus said, “I am the way, the truth and the life; no man comes to the Father except through Me.”

2. Abundant life on earth.

John 10:10

“The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy; I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full.”

John 15:8

“This is to my Father's glory, that you bear much fruit, showing yourselves to be my disciples.”

Matthew 6:33

“But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.”

- When we put the Kingdom of God our top priority, God will provide health and prosperity as well as meet all your needs.

CONCLUSION

Let us seek first God's kingdom and His righteousness then we can be assured we will have everything that we need in life.